

The Price War

Visual direction for the turn-based economics game. 17 screens covering the full match arc — entry, play loop, edge states, end-of-match, and meta.

PALETTE Adam's Axioms · royal blue + cool greys	TYPE Source Serif 4 + Inter
SCREENS 17 across 6 sections	STACK React + TypeScript

The Price War

Leaderboard

History

1326 elo



WELCOME BACK

Ready for another round?

You're on a **3-match win streak**. Marina's been knocking on your bracket — she might be next.

Quick match →

Choose scenario

Practice vs CPU

WINS

24

LOSSES

9

STREAK

3

BEST MARGIN

\$2.1k

RECENT MATCHES

Marina K.
\$5,120 vs \$3,890

+18

Ben (CPU · Hard)
\$4,640 vs \$4,210

+12

Wren O.
\$2,950 vs \$4,830

-24

See all →



PROF. ALDO · DAILY TIP

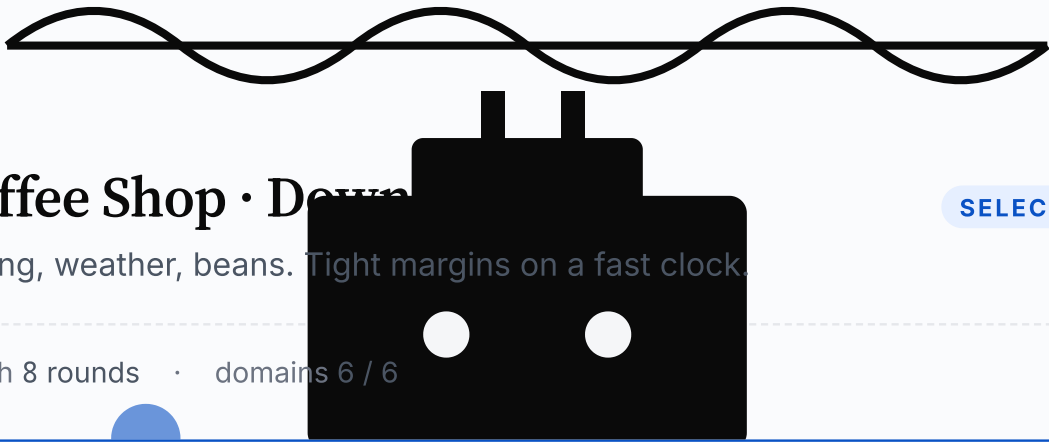
“Pricing too low against a streaky opponent makes you predictable. Try one premium round to flip the read.”

← Lobby

CHOOSE YOUR BATTLEGROUND

Where are we trading punches today?

Scenarios change which domains matter, the round count, and what your opponent can throw at you.



Coffee Shop · Downpour

Pricing, weather, beans. Tight margins on a fast clock.

match 8 rounds · domains 6 / 6

SELECTED



Food Truck · Lunch rush

Location plays, supply runs, hourly demand. Short, punchy matches.

match 5 rounds · domains 5 / 6

LOCKED

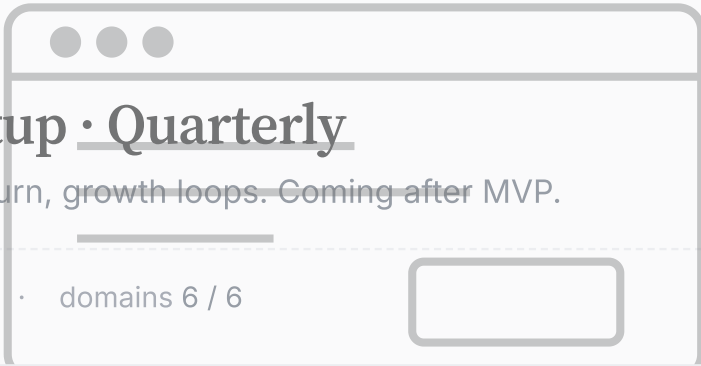


Bookshop · Holiday push

Inventory + events. Slower, more strategic. Marketing matters.

match 10 rounds · domains 4 / 6

LOCKED



SaaS Startup · Quarterly

Pricing tiers, churn, growth loops. Coming after MVP.

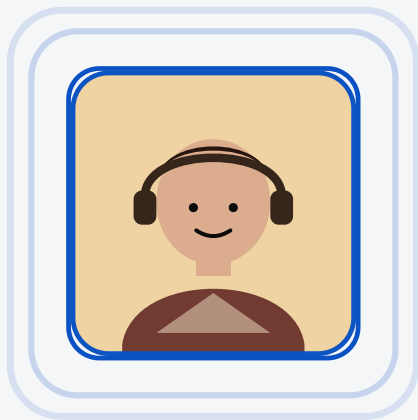
match 12 rounds · domains 6 / 6

LOCKED

Queue Coffee Shop →

Practice solo

← Cancel



SEARCHING FOR AN OPPONENT

Finding someone in your league...

YOUR ELO	SEARCHING RANGE	IN QUEUE
1,326	1,180 – 1,470	00:14



Range widens every 30s.

Cancel search



OPPONENT LOCATED · COFFEE SHOP · DOWNTOWN

You've drawn Marina.

8 rounds. Ranked match. Elo at stake: ± 24 .



vs



You

Elo 1,326



Last 5

Marina K.

Elo 1,284



Last 5

PLAYSTYLE HINT Marina leans **aggressive** · **discount-heavy**.

Begin Round 1 →



PROF. ALDO · THE BELL

“She’ll come out swinging — discounters always do. Don’t match her first move out of fear. Read the demand, then commit.”



YOU
You
\$4,250

COFFEE SHOP · DOWNTOWN

Round 3 / 8

0:42 until reveal

OPPONENT · ELO 1284

Marina K.

their menu

375¢

Locked





PROF. ALDO · COACH

“Marina just locked at 375¢ — a clear discount. If you stay premium, hold your nerve. If you blink, blink hard.”

YOUR HAND · ROUND 3

Pick up to 3 moves

- Sales
- Procurement
- Operations
- HR
- Marketing
- Finance



Set price
Update your menu price for the next round.

MENU PRICE

425¢

Marina is at 375¢. You're above her.

Sales

effect · balancedcost \$0

Draft move



Flash sale
Temporary cut to drive volume this round only.

DISCOUNT

-15%

Costs \$120 in lost margin. Won't carry forward.

Sales

effect · ≈ +60 cups this roundcost \$120

✓ Drafted



Premium blend
Launch a higher-margin specialty drink line.

SPECIALTY PRICE

650¢

One-time \$420 launch cost. Persists across rounds.

Sales

effect · +margin · brand liftcost \$420

Draft move



Bundle deal
Coffee + pastry combo to lift average ticket.

BUNDLE PRICE

575¢

Burns through pastry inventory faster.

Sales

effect · +ticket · sit-downcost \$180

Draft move



Match rival
Track the opponent's public price automatically.

PRICING RULE

Match exact

Undercut 5%

Sets to ~356¢ next round.

My picks

1 / 3

Flash sale-15%

×

SLOT 2 · EMPTY

SLOT 3 · EMPTY

Spend this round

After commit

- \$120

\$4,130

Review & lock 1 move →

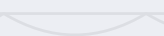
You can revise until both players lock.

• SALES

effect · follows · aggressive

cost \$0

Draft move



YOU

You

\$4,130

COFFEE SHOP · DOWNTOWN

Round 3 / 8

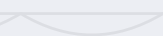
● ● ● ● ● ● ● ●

● reveal at 0:00 until reveal

OPPONENT · ELO 1284

Marina K.

their menu **375¢**



ROUND 3 · AWAITING REVEAL

You've locked. Marina is still thinking.

Reveal happens when both sides commit, or when her timer runs out.



You

• LOCKED

vs



Marina K.

• CHOOSING

YOUR SEALED ORDERS



Flash sale

-15% this round

SEALED



Buy beans

4 sacks · \$880

SEALED



Local poster run

\$240

SEALED

Unlock & revise

Forfeit match



PROFITABLE WHILE WE WAIT

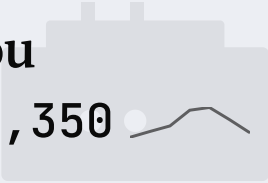
“Most players over-react after a loss. If she stays cheap and you keep flashing sales, you both bleed. Plan the next two rounds, not just this one.”



YOU

You

\$3,350



COFFEE SHOP · DOWNTOWN

Round 3 / 8

next

round

until reveal



OPPONENT · ELO 1284

Marina K.

their menu 375¢



ROUND 2 · RESOLVED

 Rainy Tuesday

-6

demand **406** cups across the block

Marina took the morning.

YOUR CASH THIS ROUND

\$900

MARINA'S CASH THIS ROUND

+\$320

 price 425¢ sold 198

sold 248

price 375¢



Continue to Round 3 →

Replay round

Back to lobby

FORFEIT · PERMANENT

Walk away from this match?

Marina takes the win. You lose **-24 Elo** and the round-3 streak resets. There's no undo.



PROF. ALDO · WAIT

“You’re 3 rounds from end. Down isn’t out. If you’re set on this, type FORFEIT below.”

TYPE FORFEIT TO CONFIRM

FORFEIT

Stay in the match

Confirm forfeit



Unlocking returns your sealed orders to drafts. Marina will see *UNSEALED* next to your name — she'll know you flinched.

Keep my picks

Unlock & revise



YOU
You
\$320

COFFEE SHOP · DOWNTOWN

Round 6 / 8

●●●●●●●●

1:12 until reveal

OPPONENT · ELO 1284

Marina K.

their menu 375¢



AUSTERITY MODE · CASH BELOW \$500

Only cheap moves are on the menu.

Spend caps to keep you in the game. Find \$300+ in cash to lift the limit.

CASH

\$320

• Sales

• Procurement

• Operations

• HR

• Marketing

• Finance

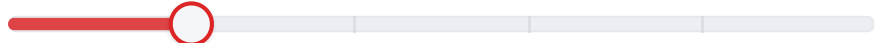


Set price

Update your menu price for the next round.

MENU PRICE

385¢



Marina is at 375¢. You're above her.

• SALES

effect · value · higher volume

cost \$0

Draft move



Match rival

Track the opponent's public price automatically.

PRICING RULE

Match exact

Undercut 5%

Sets to ~356¢ next round.

• SALES

effect · follows · aggressive

cost \$0

Draft move

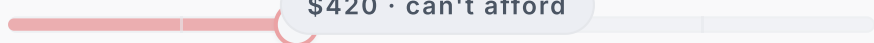


Premium blend

Launch a higher-margin specialty drink line.

SPECIALTY PRICE

650¢



\$420 · can't afford

One-time \$420 launch cost. Persists across rounds.

• SALES

effect · +margin · brand lift

cost \$420

Draft move

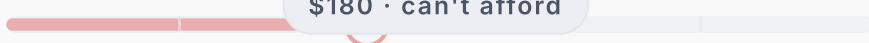


Bundle deal

Coffee + pastry combo to lift average ticket.

BUNDLE PRICE

575¢



\$180 · can't afford

Burns through pastry inventory faster.

• SALES

effect · +ticket · sit-down

cost \$180

Draft move

My picks



Match rival
undercut 5%

×

SLOT 2 · EMPTY

SLOT 3 · EMPTY

Lock 1 move →



PROF. ALDO · LAST LEGS

“When you're broke, you stop trying to win and start trying not to lose more. Match her price, keep inventory thin, survive to next round. Heroics will end you.”



ROUND 6 · MATCH CONCLUDED

The till is empty.

You've burned through your cash reserve. The shop can't make payroll.
Marina wins by liquidity.



You

-\$240

BANKRUPT



Marina K.

\$4,820

WINNER

-32 Elo · now 1,294

Replay this match →

Practice cash management

Back to lobby



PROF. ALDO · AFTER THE BELL

“You spent like you'd win. You won't always. Half the game is what you do before things go sideways — buy cheap, hold cash, take the small fight. Try again.”

MATCH · ROUND 4 OF 8

Marina stepped out.

Her connection dropped after Round 3. She has 2:00 to come back — after that, we'll resolve the match in your favor.



vs



You

\$4,920 · leading

Marina K.

Disconnected · 0:58 ago

WAITING FOR RECONNECT

1:02 LEFT

IF SHE DOESN'T RETURN

Partial-credit win

+12 Elo

Half the normal stake. Saved as a partial-match in your history.

Resolve now (+12 Elo)

Wait for her



PROF. ALDO · SPORTSMANSHIP

“A win is a win. But the rating doesn't tell the full story of a match like this — and you know it. Take the half-Elo, log it, find a better fight.”

MATCH · COFFEE SHOP · 8 ROUNDS

You won the morning.

+24 Elo · now 1,350



YOU

Final cash

\$5,820

ROUNDS WON

5

BEST ROUND

+\$1.2k

AVG PRICE

438¢



MARINA K.

Final cash

\$4,140

ROUNDS WON

3

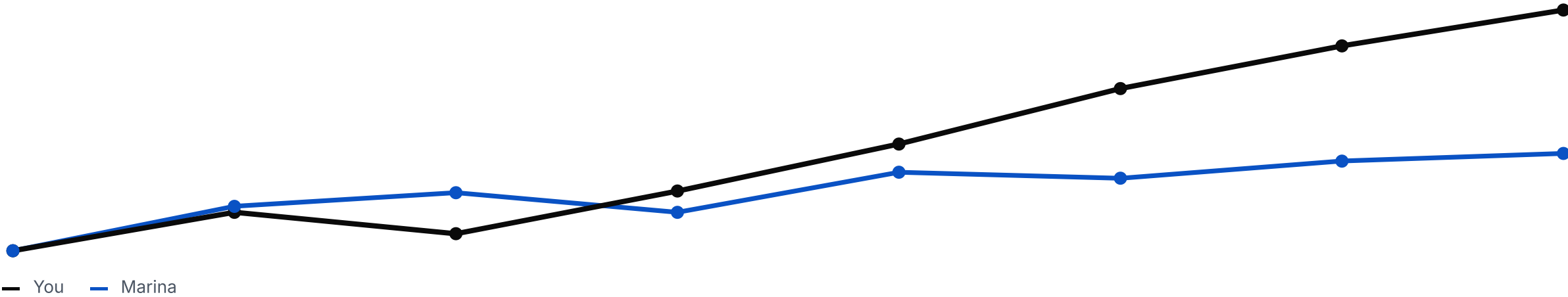
BEST ROUND

+\$680

AVG PRICE

371¢

CASH TRAJECTORY · 8 ROUNDS



Play again →

Rematch Marina

Back to lobby



PROF. ALDO · DEBRIEF

“Round 5 is what won it for you. You stopped trying to win on price and won on perception. That's the lesson — write it down.”

A decorative header banner for a coffee shop. It features a light gray background with a white scalloped border at the top. In the center, the text "COFFEE SHOP · DOWNTOWN" is written in a small, sans-serif font. Below this, "Round 1 / 3" is displayed in a large, bold, black serif font. Underneath the round number are three small circles: the first is blue, and the other two are gray. Below the circles is a white rounded rectangle containing the text "no timer until reveal" in a small, gray, sans-serif font. On the left side, there is a yellow square icon with a brown border containing a stylized person wearing a headset. To its right, the text "YOU" is in a small, gray font, followed by "You" in a large, bold, black serif font, and "\$5,000" in a large, bold, black serif font. A small white circle is positioned to the right of the "\$5,000". On the right side, there is a blue square icon with a white border containing a stylized person wearing a cap. To its left, the text "OPPONENT · ELO 1000" is in a small, gray font, followed by "Coach Aldo (Practice)" in a large, bold, black serif font. Below this, the text "their menu" is in a small, gray font, followed by "400¢" in a large, bold, black serif font. A gray coffee cup icon is positioned to the left of the "400¢".

“Welcome. First match — I’ll walk you through. Every round, you pick up to 3 moves from your hand. Let’s start with the simplest one: Set price.”

YOUR HAND • TUTORIAL ROUND 1

Try setting a price

- Sales ● Procurement ● Operations ● HR ● Marketing ● Finance

Draft move

COACH'S NUDGE

Drag the slider, then draft.

Move the slider to set your price. Below 400¢ is cheap. Above 500¢ is premium. Drafting just adds the move to your picks — you can still revise.

Goal: draft one move and lock the round.

Skip tutorial

← Lobby



PROFILE

You

joined Apr 2026 · playstyle **balanced** · **patient** · main **Coffee Shop**



ELO
1,326
+42 last week

MATCH HISTORY

Marina K. \$5,120 vs \$3,890 · 8 rounds	+18
Ben (CPU · Hard) \$4,640 vs \$4,210	+12
Wren O. \$2,950 vs \$4,830 · forfeited R6	-24
Sasha B. \$5,890 vs \$4,110	+15
Marina K. \$4,980 vs \$4,210	+14
Dom V. \$3,810 vs \$4,920	-19

HIGHLIGHTS

WINS 24	LOSSES 9
STREAK 3	BEST MARGIN \$2,140
AVG ROUND +\$280	FAVOURITE MOVE Premium blend



PROF. ALDO · READ ON YOU
“You hold pricing nerve well — but you forfeit on bad luck more than you should. One bad round isn't a match. Stay in.”

← Lobby

LADDER

Who's calling the prices.

Coffee Shop

Global

Friends

2



Dom V.

1,681

128 · 44

L1 ↓ 8

1



Aiko T.

1,742

142 · 38

W6 ↑ 18

3



Wren O.

1,623

111 · 52

W2 ↑ 5

RANK	PLAYER	ELO	RECORD	STREAK	7D
4	 Sasha B.	1,592	98 · 51	W4	↑ 12
5	 Marina K.	1,284	54 · 38	W1	↑ 6
14	 You YOU	1,326	24 · 9	W3	↑ 42
15	 Ben C.	1,318	40 · 28	L2	↓ 4



PROF. ALDO · YOUR CLIMB

“You're 320 Elo from the top 5 in Coffee Shop. Three good weeks. Don't chase the leaders' style — be unpredictable, not impressive.”

← Lobby

INBOX · 2 UNREAD

Word from the floor.

- AllMatchesSocialSystemMark all read



Marina wants a rematch

You beat her +18 yesterday. She queued up for round 2.

5m

Accept rematch →



Weekly ladder reset in 2 days

You're 14th. Top 10 earns a portrait frame.

2h

See standings →



Match resolved · Marina K.

Partial credit win. +12 Elo. She didn't reconnect.

Yesterday

View match →



Sasha B. followed you

They climbed to #4 last week.

Yesterday



New scenario in beta · Food Truck

Lunch-rush variant. 5 rounds. Apply to test.

3d

Join beta →

WHAT TO PING ME ABOUT

Rematch invites



Match resolutions



New followers



Ladder reset & rewards



New scenarios



Coach's weekly read

